The Peninsular Courier

Published Every Friday,

Has a large circulation among Merchants, Mechanics, Manufacturers, Farmers, and Families generally.

DESIRABLE MEDIUM FOR ADVERTISERS.

R. A. BEAL, Publisher and Proprietor.

Terms: $1 50 a year in advance. $2 00 if payment is delayed. Single copies, five cents.

BOOK AND JOB PRINTING

OF EVERY DESCRIPTION,

CHEAPER THAN ANY OTHER HOUSE IN THE WEST.

Office—41 and 43 North Main Street.



VOLUME XIII.—No. 21. ANN ARBOR, MICHIGAN, FRIDAY, MAY 22, 1874. WHOLE NUMBER 674.

STATE AND COUNTY OFFICERS.

Members of Congress.

State Officers.

Members of Legislature.

County Officers.

CITY CHURCH DIRECTORY.

Baptist Church.

Catholic Church.

Congregational Church.

Episcopal Church.

Lutheran Church.

Methodist Church.

Presbyterian Church.

Unitarian Church.

BUSINESS CARDS.

D. F. ALLMENDINGER
Tuner and repairer of
Organs, Melodeons,
Violins,
ACCORDEONS, &c., &c.
Shop—Cor. Washington and Fifth streets, Ann Arbor, Michigan.

J. F. SCHAEBERLE,
Gives lessons on the
PIANO, VIOLIN AND GUITAR.
Piano pupils can obtain the most thorough instruction, such as to enable them to play in public, at the lowest terms. Residence, 1st Door from Washington. Orders for Piano tuning promptly attended to and satisfaction guaranteed by all pupils. Residence 47 South State Street, Ann Arbor.

EDWARD D. KINNE,
ATTORNEY AT LAW.
Office removed from Court House to
Slawson's Block,
Entrance formerly occupied by Post & Grant,
ANN ARBOR, MICHIGAN.

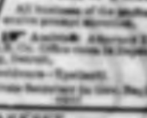
WILLIAM HERZ,
HOUSE, SIGN, ORNAMENTAL & FRESCO PAINTER.
Painting, Glazing, Gilding and Paper Hanging, and work of every description done in the best style, and warranted to give satisfaction. Shop in E. Ward's Block, Washington Street, Ann Arbor. 1y19

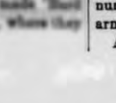
F. SIGG,
Keeps Fine and Unexpensive Clothing, Gents' Furnishing Goods, Hats and Caps, and such other articles usually kept in a first class store. Opera Hats, Silk and Paragon Vests, Fine Dress Shirts, Kossuth Hats, Shoe Pacs, Felt Boots, Rubbers, &c. Cor. Washington and Main Sts., Ann Arbor, Mich.

ANN ARBOR
MINERAL SPRINGS
H. HALE, M. D.,
Superintendent.
Office in building,
NO. 8 AND 9 WEST HURON STS.

MRS. M. J. HILTON, M. D.
Physician and Surgeon,
Office and residence No. 46 Ann Street, east of Depot.
Office hours: 9 to 10 A. M. and 2 to 4 P. M.
Residence: Prof. Sager, Prof. Frieze's.

GEORGE E. HOPKINS,
LAWYER,
All business of the profession will receive prompt attention.
Office over E. A. & H. Co. Office room in Dwight Block.
Residence—Upstairs.
Private Entrance to Office, Rear Door.

N. ARKSEY,
Manufacturer of

CARRIAGES, BUGGIES, WAGONS and SLEIGHS of every style, made of the best material, and warranted to give satisfaction. Repairing done promptly, and prices reasonable. Shop on Detroit Street, Ann Arbor. 1y19

WILLIAM W. NICHOLS,

DENTIST;
Successor to E. W. Nordby. Office, 19 North Main Street, opposite National Bank. Residence, 36 Lib. Street. Nitrous oxide gas administered when required.

THE AYMERS.

CHAPTER XIV.

[Conclusion of the Chapter.]

The Hermit Crab, unlik other crustaceans that have tails, has a soft tail. It is long, and shaped like the fabled dragon's tail. To prevent his neighbors from biting this off, and to preserve it from other harm, he finds an empty shell and inserts the soft extremity in its spiral labyrinth where, fortunately for him, it just fits.

Where was the whelk himself?

Dead and gone—where, and by what agency, I don't know. May be old age, may be violence. I only know that those shells, emptied of their original tenants, are frequent along the shore. As intimated already, this is fortunate for the Hermit, for there could be no Hermit without a Hermitage.

The Hermit Crab, like the lobster, grows by "moulding," or casting its shell, which shell itself never grows. Of course the old housings will not do for the hermit when he has grown a "stretch," and he is obliged to look up a new one. He goes around like a human house-hunter, among the unoccupied shells on the shore, and views them with a critical eye. Sometimes he backs into one that is too large for him, big as he thinks he has grown, and he drags himself out again with a chopfallen air and goes on. It sometimes happens that one attempts to dispossess a brother hermit of his shell, and possess it himself. This is when the brother's shell is a desirable one. Such disregard of the tenth commandment is quite after the style of men, and—I think I will forego the little joke that I meditated at Mr. Darwin's expense. These attempts at ejectment result in a fight, and the fighting is generally so spirited that the Hermit Crab is called, also, the *Soldier* Crab.

When our friends were done interviewing Hermit Crab, alias Soldier Crab, they put him into the dory with the scallop and left him.

Among the sea weeds at the edge of the water, Isabella picked up two or three little purple sea fish, with each of their five fingers curled under them as if in mortal agony. And no wonder, for a little further back where the crows had been, were fragments of half a dozen more. This was evidence that the crows had been breakfasting. Equally strong evidence that the gulls had been drinking, as seen in the dark red feathers they had moulted out, and which were lying not far off from the remnants of the crows' feast.

On the higher parts of the ledge was a luxuriant growth of the common sea weeds. Lower down these were more rare, and intermixed with other growths, and large patches of the Irish moss appeared. Many were the wonderful things they found in the little pools left by the retiring tide—animals and plants—and there were about these a brightness, and freshness, and crispness, that were striking.

They returned to the dory, each laden with Irish moss, which was destined, when bleached, to transportation to that suburban town of which I spoke in the beginning, and consumption by the Aymer family. This was its destiny, they thought.

When they had re-embarked they floated on around the lower end of the ledge. Here the plants were more numerous. Most frequent was a kind with small stems five or six inches long, and single, lanceolate leaves a foot and a half in length, and six inches wide. They were of the color of the kelp, and the leaves were neither ribbed, nor veined, but were gathered at the stalk, as women gather the skirts of a dress at the waist. Mingled with these, and swayed by the same impulse, were bright clusters of delicate dulse, and other forms more fragile yet, and colored pale green, and rosy red, and brilliant carmine. And there were sea anemones that, contracted, clung to the rocks like hemispherical cakes of wax, or, expanded, bloomed like beds of daisies. And there were tufts of dark, hair-like filaments, that streamed upward—Lyonisti locks—beholding which Isabella clapped her hands, and cried,

"Mermaiden's hair!"

But Count and Philip were agreed in pronouncing them "Sea Horses' tails."

When they had gone a little further, the water suddenly grew quite deep; still, however, the tops of the great kelps were above the surface, for they were yet within the limits of the "laminarian zone" [kelp zone], which extends from low water mark to a depth of fifteen fathoms. "Bard" had been pushing the dory along with the oyster, and now when he could not reach bottom with it, still held it in his hand with the end in the water. Out from the kelps slowly sailed a great ruinor. He swam up to the barbed point and seemed to study it attentively.

"Punch his head!" cried Count.

"Why?" said Bard. And then to the ruinor, "Do not trespass me. Go directly away, or you may come to grief. This is a spear."

The ruinor seemed to understand, and with one whisk of his tail disappeared whence he came. No doubt he said to himself, "I hoped it was a clam. I could relish a good fat one, but not any fish spears for me—no, no!"

"Where shall we go next?" asked Bard, as he shook the drops of water from the spear, and laid it down in the dory.

"Up to the bar," said Count at first, and then—"Oh, no, let's go over and see the umbrella tree!"

"Oh, yes, the umbrella tree!" echoed Philip and Isabella.

The umbrella tree was on an island, just across the channel from them. They rowed across, landed, and climbed the high bank. A few steps took them to the edge of a growth of trees, one of which was the tree in question. It was a cut spruce, with a trunk about five inches in diameter. At a height of eight or nine feet it threw out its first branches. They were very long. A series of shorter ones succeeding, terminating in the summit less than three feet above the lower branches. The thick foliage was almost impervious to rain, and in that respect, as well as in appearance, it did resemble a gigantic umbrella.

What is a cut spruce?

Well, I hardly know. Burnett describe only two kinds of spruce, *Abies nigra*, black, or double spruce, and *Abies alba*, white spruce. In the neighborhood where these woods occurred, it is sometimes called *Burgundy* spruce—for this reason,—

There once landed on these shores, from a coasting vessel, an individual who might have been, so far as appearances went then, the subject of that interlocutory ditty the mariners sing.

Question—"What shall I do with the drunken sailor?"

Answer—"Put him in the long boat and make him bail her."

But he proved to be, instead, an English physician and surgeon of great acquirements, and no mean experience, having fresh from the wards of a London Hospital—the King's daughter home, he called it—where he spent seven years. This man, on beholding the cut spruce, exclaimed,—

"Ha! Burgundy spruce! Your Burgundy pitch don't cost you much."

If this brief mention of him has interested any one in the Dr. and his fortunes, I will say for their further information that he resumed the practice of medicine not far from where he landed. You will have some idea of his success when I say that it is still in dispute—after more than thirty years—whether his professional brethren poisoned him, or, as they said, "he died of his cups."

The peculiar characteristics of cut spruce are darker foliage, smoother bark, a pungent odor—cut—and a profusion of white pitch. And it is a very ornamental tree. Where the children were it was an umbrella tree. Ten yards south of them—among other spruces—it was shaped like other spruces. Ten yards south, in the open space, it was a bushire tree. One of these was right in their path. It was about twenty inches high, with lower branches on the ground, and shaped exactly like the artistic bushires. The branches were so numerous, and the foliage so dense, that it was impenetrable to all things, except bullets. Going back to the dory Philip kicked it, and he and Count turned back after passing it; but no impression was made upon it either by kicks or stones. A small rat might have crawled into it, but no bird lodged in its branches—not even a hovering bird.

Next they rowed up to "the bar," which was a bed of mussels just out of water when the tide was down, and locked as one might fancy the back of the sea serpent does, when he scuds around at the service of the water. They were rowed cautiously along, looking over the side, and when they were close to the bar the oars stopped, and they all set up a shout of wonder and admiration.

What did they shout about?

At what they saw on the bottom. There was, between the bare, black mussels of the bar, and the line of eel-grass out in the water, a space fifteen or twenty feet in width. This was composed of mussels, also, but while those on the bar looked in six every twelve hours, these could only look up at that element through the intervening water. And just now they could not do that, even, on account of the numbers of star-fish that were spread about and piled up over them. It was on beholding these that our friends shouted. They were of all sizes and colors—colors peculiar to star-fish,—and were down through the clear water were a sight to excite the admiration of any one and make him shout.

"Say," said Isabella, her usual dignity quite upset, "let's each choose the one we think prettiest, and nobody tell their choice till we're all done choosing."

"I'll take no all day just to look at 'em," said Count, glancing back and forth where, in two directions, ran this subaqueous milky way.

"I mean those around us now," said Isabella.

Her proposition was agreed to, and tongues became quiet while eyes were active.

"I've picked," said Count.

"And I," said Isabella.

Philip was last, and then they told Count's choice was one that had lost two points, but was not otherwise remarkable, while Isabella's and "Bard's were both of medium size, but not of the same color. Isabella's was pink, and "Bard's purple. After the selections had been made "Bard hooked them up to the surface, where they were seized with the hand.

Now you may be, some of you, desirous of knowing what kind of an animal a star-fish is. The common *star-fish*, or five-fingered Jack—sounds low, does Jack? Well, then, the *Asterias vulgaris* is partly described by its name. It is star-shaped, having five rays, or points. The one Philip had made choice of was fifteen or twenty inches across. Some of those that I subsequently found in the sea weed when they landed on the ledges, would have been exhibited on a sickle-seat and no part would have been rejected. Those sizes are the exception. A hard skin, rough with sharp prickles, covers the back of the star fish. On the under side channels extend from the center where the stomach is situated, to the end of the points. The hard skin of the back extends around to the margin of these channels, so that when the star fish lies on his back the channels resemble miniature ditches with chevaux-de-frise. The channels themselves are lined with successful tentacles, which the animal can project out an inch or more, at its pleasure. The extremity of each tentacle is armed with a little disk that attaches itself to anything by the expulsion of the air. A free and judicious use of these natural instruments, enables the star fish to clamber about over all kinds of surfaces—slowly, of course, but there is progression. The eyes are five, one at the end of each point, and as the creature grows larger they grow smaller. Just how serviceable they are we don't know. If the star fish loses an arm, another grows out. He cannot lose a leg for he has none. His food consists of mussels, beach cockles, etc. When he has selected one of these for dinner, or supper, as the time of day may be, he arches itself over it, and grasps it with his points, and then his stomach comes, like a great bubble, out of his mouth and enfolds the victim. The effect of this is to bring out the inhabitant of the shell, and the star fish "makes his meal." So you see that when one old roper asks another what kind of a drink he will put himself outside of, he does not speak of a thing unknown in the realm of nature. It is a great pity that all ropers are not obliged to take their drams in exactly that way.

I don't know how many star fish "Bard fished up—a good many, though—and then they rowed home. The scallop, meantime, through some sense or other, of the presence of his old neighbors, the star fish, in the dory, opened his valves a little and disclosed a row of black dots between.

The whole party reached the house laden with spoils, and I will tell you what happened to it all. They spread the Irish Moss out on the ground to bleach. You envy them that, do you? You needn't, for the sheep got at it, and ate it all up. You may envy the sheep if you wish to.

"Bard boiled the scallop and divided the meat all around. The pieces were so small that they could only taste the vinegar and pepper that were put on them. No one remarked the fact, though. The shells were given to Isabella.

The star fish were put out to dry. They tried at first to run off, putting their innumerable tentacles in motion, but somehow they didn't seem to get on. Then, giving away to despair, they burst into tears, and fairly flooded the boards on which they lay. And then they dried up and faded, becoming regular mummies.

The Hermit Crab was put over a door and forgotten for a week. When Bard took him down at the end of that time, he was projected out of his shell like one of those figures that dart out of a box, when you start the lid, and scare you half to death. His whole frame was rigid, and his eyes stared frightfully.

The tresses of mermaiden's hair, the clusters of dulse, the sea weeds with the great bells on them, and the eel grass with the *Hippolithion phyllanthicum* on it, were all deposited in the wood house. Thither two days afterwards Bowers and Isabella went to admire, and behold, they had lost all their freshness, were blackened and an offensive odor proceeded from them. This, however, was immaterial to the pigs, to whom they were immediately tossed.

The fact is that never so beautiful a thing will fade, or grow hideous, out of its element. On this principle you can account for swearing, stealing, murdering, lying, and all reprehensible of character in beings "created a little lower than the angels." They are out of their proper element.

This is a lesson to you, my young friends. What "Bard with his fish spear was to the star fish, the Evil One, with his temptations, is to you. But, more fortunate than they, you can resist successfully, if you will. Be on your guard, then. Don't let him fish you out of your proper element.

[To be Continued.]

FOREIGN CORRESPONDENCE.

Number LXXV.

TAMSUI, FORMOSA, December 1st, 1873.

After more than two weeks' stay among the Sek-whan at Posia, we finally got ready to move out toward the coast. Our stay had impressed me at least with the Christian kindness and hospitality of this rude people. Without the crafty and niggardly spirit of the Chinese, we could hardly prevail upon them to take pay for what we bought of them, poor as they are.

As we left them, one peng-an and shake of the hand was not sufficient; but old men and women would run on before us, and take a new turn at it blessing us and asking us to remember them when we got back to our own Christian lands, and to tell the Christians there that they were trying to do right. Quite a party of men and women accompanied us a couple of miles, wading the river, to bid us a last farewell. It is a two days' march through the territory of the Che-whan before the cultivated country of the Chinese is reached, and the Sek-whan only pass through in large bands, that they may be safe from attack. Our party numbered about seventy, most of them armed with firelocks.

All of the first day we followed down the river, now quite a stream, with all the branches from the valley of Posia united; so that we found it difficult to ford, though we had to do so several times during the day. About noon we heard a deer bleating near the path, and several men dashed off after it, thinking it was caught in a snare, such as the Sek-whan often use for the purpose; but it happened that the deer—one of a small species—had been caught in the claws of a large eagle that was not able to fly off with it. The eagle, on seeing the men, flew away, and the deer, dazed at first, ran to the men who, not expecting anything of the kind, were not prepared to shoot, and after striking at it with a knife, lost it. When they returned and told the story, they gave as a reason for not capturing it, that their Heavenly Father had not given it to them.

Just before stopping for the night, we passed through a fine valley, where several hundred Sek-whan once settled, the walls of the houses, and the ditches and terraces for irrigation still existing, but overgrown with bushes and wild grass. After losing a hundred men from repeated attacks of the Che-whan, they had to give the settlement up and retreat to a safer place. Crossing the river at this place for the last time, we came to a number of grass covered huts under a wooded bank, where such parties as ours were accustomed to pass the night, and there were soon a dozen camp fires burning, while several of the party took their guns and went off to hunt, and others turned the little brook, that ran near, out of its course, and got a good supply of shrimps and small fish. After supper, all gathered together for worship, and then several hymns were sung to their own wild music, and the camp gradually settled down to sleep.

The next morning we crossed a steep mountain and down into the valley of a small stream, that had cut a channel a hundred feet deep in some places, through drift, leaving perpendicular walls on either side. In some places this channel was but five or six feet in width, so that we walked in single file. The drift was often very coarse, and there were many trunks of trees that had partially or entirely turned to coal. We could tell when we had reached nearly to the boundary of Chinese settlement, by seeing the hills bare of trees and covered with coarse grass. Several of these hills had little watch houses built upon them, from which to warn the people of the approach of the Che-whan, and we could see men upon these watching us, and could hear them call to others beyond to let them know of our coming. These little stations are often the scenes of bloody encounters between the Chinese and savages, and we were pointed to one where the Che-whan had stolen up at night, with dry grass, and burned the Chinese to death.

We could now begin to see the Chinese at work, cutting timber and grass on the hills, and soon after we came out into the great plain east of the large walled city of Chungwha. That night we stopped with a very hospitable Chinaman, though an opium smoker, and owner of a large estate, much of it planted to sugar cane, a part of which was already being ground, and made up into a rather dark grade of sugar. We understood that the little watch towers we had seen were supported by this man personally, as his estate borders upon the savage territory. He treated us to a genuine Chinese supper of a dozen or more little bowls of fish, flesh and fowl, with vegetables, cooked in different ways. He sat down with us, and was very polite, putting bits of whatever he considered especially nice upon our plates, using his chop sticks as a means of conveyance.

Three hours' walk the next morning brought us to Toasia, a town of the Sek-whan, and, as near as we could find out, the original home of the tribe. The lands about it are very rich, and were covered with a very heavy crop of rice that was just being harvested; but the most of the fields have fallen into the hands of the Chinese, and those still held by the Sek-whan are covered with debt.

The Tungson, the head man of the Sek-whan, who has bought a small mandarin ship of the Chinese, lives in this place, and he immediately set about making a great feast in honor of our arrival, killing a cow, a couple of hogs, fowls, etc. Three or four great kettles were set up near the little chapel, and filled and set to boiling, and there was an immense amount of preparation. The table was spread in the chapel, and there were some forty or fifty to dinner, and enough for twice as many. There were no toasts, but the Tungson told some of the grievances of the Sek-whan, from their grasping neighbors, the Chinese, with the hope, perhaps, that Mr. Bullock, being connected with the English consulate, could help them out.

We parted company at this place, Mr. Bullock returning to Taiwaufu, by way of Chungwha, while Mr. Campbell and I went on north twelve or fifteen miles, to the Sek-whan settlement of Laisia. This is a very pretty valley among the hills, containing two villages and, perhaps, eight hundred people,—all Christians, or, at least, all worshipers, as there is not an idol or tablet in either of the villages. They received their first ideas of Christianity from the old hunter Kisanhia, who had been treated at the missionary hospital at Taiwaufu, and they threw away their idols and received Christianity almost in one day. They received us very kindly, and, as in Posia, they had a little house built for the missionaries when they should visit them, and in this we proceeded to make ourselves comfortable.

I was very much amused with the salutation we received every day as we came from dinner at the house of the helper near by. There were generally half a dozen old women who cried out: "Chiah-pah-la?"—have you eaten until you are full?—this seeming to be the nearest complete happiness that this poor people can think of attaining on this earth.

They were expecting to begin their harvest the next week, and were busy preparing for it by distilling a weak spirit from rice. The missionaries are not Americans, and have only counseled them to moderation, instead of enjoining entire abstinence. There were large hunting parties out, also, that brought in three wild hogs, one of them very large and with enormous tusks. They are black, and probably only the ordinary Chinese breed run wild, though there is a curious and very small species found upon the island.

Mr. Campbell and I, while at Laisia, made a trip to a town inhabited by Hakkas, called Twalam, some ten miles south east, where we expected to see more Che-whan, as it is a point where they frequently come to trade. This was the first place where I had seen Hakkas, though the northern part of the island has almost as many of them as of other Chinese. They are supposed to come from the province of Canton, though they do not speak Cantonese. They do not bandage the feet of their women, generally live apart from the other Chinese, and are called Ke-lang, or strangers, by them. They are a hardy, industrious race, and seem to be braver than the ordinary Chinese, as they generally occupy the frontier next the savages. We saw no savages but two or three women, who, by similarity of tattooing, would seem to be closely allied to those we saw east of Posia. Their villages are very near those of the Chinese here, as they pointed out brown patches on the mountain sides a few miles back, where their settlements were.

The country about Twalam was much of it high table land, without water for irrigation, and hence uncultivated and grown up to a tall feather grass. These table lands were likely, at no very distant time, part of the valleys, but the streams have cut down to another level and left them high and dry. The streams cut through badly tilted strata of coarse sandstone, in which I found quite a number of fossils.

The Sek-whan had bought, by general subscription, four dollars' worth of fish poison, a root raised by the Chinese, and one morning twenty-five or thirty men and women, the men all with fire locks, for we were going into the country of the Che-whan, set out up the little stream upon which the villages are built. We must have gone five or six miles over the worst road possible, fording the stream every few minutes, and then climbing steep banks through the thorns, until we had finally reached a spot deemed favorable, where there was a deep pool. Men and women now sat down upon the rocks, and began beating the roots they had brought for poisoning the fish. This mess was then put into the upper end of the pool, gradually going down with the current, and turning the water to a milky whiteness. While waiting for this to have its effect upon the fish, the people gathered in little groups to take their dinner, a blessing being reverently asked in each group over the little basket of rice and pickled cabbage that formed their simple fare. They brought me of the best they had, and one of them whittled out a stick to serve me for a spoon. By the time dinner was over, the fish began to rise to the top of the water, and to go swimming about on their sides, coming out to the banks as if in search of purer water. The Whans now began spearing them, and taking them in nets, following the poison down stream; but, though two or three quite large fish were caught, the affair turned out rather a failure for some reason that I could not find out.

Mr. Campbell now turned back toward the south end of the island, while I hired three young men of the Sek-whan to carry my baggage and collections, and with my boy Onga to act as interpreter, I started for Tamsui. From Laisia we traveled some fifteen or twenty miles over hills and rolling lands, mostly of reddish clay. They were thinly inhabited, from lack of water; but they had been cleared of timber generally, and were now covered with coarse, high grass. Wherever this was burned off, it showed stumps and trunks of huge camphor trees. In one place I saw one standing of seven or eight feet in diameter, while in places a little sheltered from the fires there was plenty of wild tea growing, I noticing in one place a tree in full bloom, thirty feet in height and a foot or more in diameter. From these hills we struck out toward the sea, coming out at the port of the city of Oulan, where there were quite a number of junks lying, and a large number of emigrants from the main land were just landing and starting off to find employment, each with his bag or basket of clothing and a huge Chinese umbrella.

From this port we again went inland, and left the rice fields, crossing high plateaus, uncultivated, with little valleys intersecting them, that were carefully irrigated, and we stopped for the night in the little town of Tung Kiang, where I passed the night in a dirty little inn filled with fleas and other creeping things.

The second day was mostly spent in traveling over high plains, with the wind blowing strong in our faces, as the north east trade wind, or monsoon, had set in. We passed several villages and the walled city of Tekcham, a large part of the population being Hakkas. The second night I stopped at a little town in the hills, and the next day made our way to Sinchin upon the river, and taking a small boat, we arrived here in the evening.

The northern part of Formosa does not seem so fertile as the southern and middle portion, and is much more too high for irrigation; but the soil of these high plains and hills seems well fitted for tea, and the cultivation of this plant seems capable of almost any amount of extension here. If these high lands were cultivated with better implements than the little Chinese plow, drawn by one cow, that only cuts a furrow two or three inches in depth, they might raise other crops during the rainy season; but the Chinaman makes irrigation do much of his work for him, letting on the water to soften the soil before he plows, and then irrigating again to soften the clods made by plowing the ground when wet, and when he can not irrigate, his cultivation is necessarily poor.

J. B. STEERE.

Four Scenes in the High Sierras.

A TRIP TO TO-SEMITE.

BY J. G. LEMMON,

Author of "Recollections of the Rebellion," "Two-gallon Range," "Sketch of Kingsley," "Pronunciation of the English Alphabet," &c., &c.

No. 6.—From To-Semite to the Silver Mines.

LEAVING TO-SEMITE.

Down, from "cloud-land," out from Paradise and on the dusty road again. No transcendent bliss here the memory of the last two weeks that we are quite unwilling, though compelled, to turn our footsteps homeward, there to digest the mental pabulum garnered. The reflection that, according to all accounts, we never shall look upon a fairer scene, caused us to pass to the last opportunity over the rim of the receding To-Semite—one of the last objects resting upon the retina of the eye, and thence preserved indelibly on memory's tablet, being the rear locality, shining, leaping fall of *Po-ho-no*, tearfully waving us a last adieu, but as recently in vieing us back to view the Great Gallery at some future day.

After To-Semite, what can mortal attractions or command description? We leave no fine cliff vistas, like Kilarea, within easy reach, no Mammoth Cave; but we have one of the most extensive and stupendous works of man. Let us make a slight detour on the way home and call the attention of the Comstock lode to our other unrivaled "scenes."

Hastily glancing, on our return by the upper road, at Sonora—the queen of California cities, embowered among the fruit orchards and vineyards,—upwardly examining the lime-stone natural bridges over Coyote creek, we approach the Calaveras grove of

"BIG TREES," AGAIN.

The great *Sequoias*—monarchs among the aristocracy—ever have power to arrest attention. Here we rest for a night; glad of the chance, ere evening shadows fall, of again roaming through the grove, measuring the stile to the upper side of the "Father of the Giants," gaze, wonder, and adore. Great preachers are these "Big Trees," preaching great truths. They tell of power, of wisdom, of far-reaching plants, but, best of all, they argue immortality for man. When we reflect that they have lived three thousand years, and as there is no natural limit to the life of the suspension, or outside growing plant, it is not unreasonable that man, with infinite imagination, of limitless conception, of boundless aspiration, of universal belief and hope; it is not unphilosophical that the spark of man is fitted for and will exist throughout eternity.

Gathering cones, sprays of foliage, and several rare flowers, and adding to our already plethoric bales, we pursue our journey up to Mosgo Valley, where the road to Lake Tahoe northward comes in, which we do not return upon but continue up the excellent turnpike eastward toward Silver Mountain.

The first part of the road is a long, tortuous climb up a crooked canon to a pass at the great elevation of 9,000 feet. Except the sublime scenery of forested mountains of lava on all sides, with dim stretches of valley between, and glistening peaks of snow in the far south, there was little to relieve the journey. Slowly the weary miles were added to the list already passed. So crooked was the road that often our camping place at night was in sight of that of the previous night, and the camp-fire of our noon halt still seen in curling smoke through the pines on the last spur below.

THE PROFESSOR'S TROUBLES AGAIN.

I welcomed all such portions of our journey for the two opposite reasons; there is always a fascination about them for me, but none for my excellent comrade the Professor. He is sure to get tired, to reflect upon the blissful past, and to regret his enlistment for this long excursion. This leads to wishing he was at home, and also to recalling how coldly the girls sweared him there and at Tahoe, and to that time he is hilariously miserable.

He imagined another reason, now, for his ill-luck. "I am an old Union soldier," said he, "much of the best part of my life was spent in defense of our country. I thought it was right and that services would be honored and loved, but the reverse is the case. My services and sufferings are ignored and my presence shunned—especially by the ladies. A pedagogue, who is a veteran soldier is, of all men, unappreciable."

I witnessed all his agony with secret joy, for it gave me the opportunity I wished for the display of my missionary spirit. I was sure, at least, of making him a proselyte to my faith. It is woman's mission to love—irrespective of birth, fortune, or position. I could hardly wait for his unmerited appeal—"don't it so?" I fiercely replied "No," to which he responded "Prove that I am wrong. Tell me more about 'Stories.'"

SERIAL STORIES BETWEEN THE SCENES.

[Told to relieve the dejected Professor].

THIRD SERIES—THE SOLDIER.

No. 1.—Story of The Unknown, a rich, talented, dashing Union Southern girl who hastened to meet the sick soldier who staggered to her father's door; supported him within, fed him, sang and played for him, obtained his history—giving hers, and in the presence of her parents, exchanged tokens with him, and begged him to get discharged from service and marry her.

No. 2.—Story of Thor, the beautiful blonde and sweet comforter, who loved the recaptured wreck of a soldier for the deeds on the battle-field and the suffering he had endured in the Southern prison-pens; besmoking him to stay with her, yet saying with Ruth of old "Where thou goest, I will go."

No. 3.—Story of Sophie, the dear little, wealthy, educated, blind girl, who, on the steamer for California, would meddle in and promenade only with the old veteran soldier, treating every care entirely to him and at last throwing herself into his arms and pleading with him to guide her through life—her stately mother witnessing and approving her choice.

No. 4.—Story of Carrie, the talented, city-bred Christian teacher, now a wife, mother, and missionary, of a Western city while confessing in the country harvest her holy love upon a bare-footed "Allen the Poor" who returned it with all ardor of his nature but through ambition for college honors, postponed the happy day and deservedly suffered death of the affections preventing him from afterwards accepting her constant love, also preventing him from subsequently responding fully to each of the other girls described in these "Stories."

Effect of Soldier's Stories. The Professor fully convinced of his error, declares, "Well, I never understood girls before," he continued with emotion, "I have often felt the warm pressure of the hand, and seen the love light in the eye, but supposed the grasp and the glance were for another; he who had money, was above reaching, or was not disgraced by military service. I shall give 'the hand respective-

The Peninsular Courier

Advertising Rates.

JOB PRINTING,

BOOK BINDING,

west cities. I hate so good a right to starve a girl on sympathy." He added emphatically, "There'll be a wedding in Huron Valley soon," and marched off to the mountain singing, "Sailing on the Yukon Sea."

SILVER MOUNTAIN.

At the dilapidated county seat of Alpine county—still nominally another city, a pleasant stretch of meadow-land, a period of a century to make the rough and difficult side of Silver Peak, 11,000 feet high, one of the highest in central California. Alone, in the still ether, I stood upon the splintered summit, above the clouds that rifled through the passes below. Chief of the splendid views from this lofty perch was the group of peaks around To-Semite, fifty miles away to the south.

Among these shone Cloud's Rest, and, more prominent if he are country, the mysterious South Half-Dome, a monument at the head of an empty colossal grave, or home, a shining land mark calling where to grow to such a second Eden.

Northward John Brown's monument, and beyond, lying around the hidden To-hee, where plainly were Job's Crystal, and Tucker's Peaks; while 20 miles further across the railroad, across the dim valley names of Castle Peak. Nearer at hand southward across Carson Valley, appeared the lower but more important mountains in a fanciful view, in the known world—the silver bearded Mt. Davidson. In the deep cuses lending to it and separating over its east side glanced the cities of Silver, Gold Hill, and Virginia. This view filled up an important interval in the observed topography of the high Sierras.

A year before I stood upon the lofty Lassen's peak in the far north. A year before that upon the gold-bearded Downieville Buttes; six months ago upon the white-crowned Castle peak, near the railroad; a month ago upon the singular John Brown's monument, last week upon the Rose-corrupted Cloud's Rest, above To-Semite; and to-day, this lofty Silver peak between the two last, commands a fine view of many of the rest. On this summit among the broken lava a "pure Florida" was found. In belonged to the Palmonacian order, and is so sensitive that it runs up from any accidental touch, expanded rays and tremblingly warned me not to wound it again.

CARSON VALLEY.

Carson Valley is one of the largest and most fertile of mountain valleys, apparently, on this coast, but its depth is retarded by a monopoly of its irrigating waters held at so high a figure that only the wealthiest farmers can buy—a matter for the Granges to look after.

Carson City is seeking substantial progress, owing to the establishment of the State buildings, the branch United States mint, and largely by the location of railshops there. We were kindly conducted through the mint—space forbids its description.

Passing up a deeply carved road eastward, visibly of heavy flight wagons, we heard from the throng of a quartz factory, then came into view of Empire, a new town built up near two very large quartz mills on the Carson river, reducing ore brought from the distant Comstock lode by railroad, and also by the old-time big quartz wagon with its 10 monster mules and one or two "lash whackers."

A SWIFT CANON.

Passing over a few divide, we were saluted by a tumultuous roar from pounding batteries, grinding machinery, and busy workmen, all pushing up from a narrow deep canon below—probably the richest in the world. Twenty-five or thirty quartz mills—some of 40 to 60 stamps—are pounding away three pretty every day in the year, reducing to the mouse and mortar machinery the silver ruined from the deep mines beneath Mt. Davidson. Around these mills are placed the handling houses, shops, saloons, etc., rising one side upon the mountain, the other upheld by piers and walls. One street through the bottom of the canon, and the buildings on each side form nearly a continuous wall. Though by their positions forming one connectedly, this densely peopled town has two names, Silver City and Gold Hill. Beyond, over another divide, by several along the slope of Davidson, the prodigy of mining towns—Virginia City—1,000 feet above the ore level; and until the founding of Treasure City, another mining town in the same State—the highest of its size in the world.

We were informed that large ore were there known, representing over 15,000 each; the Comstock lode beneath, running more than twice as much building material, and this had increased our anxiety to descend to the depths of the most expensive, most expensively worked and best paying mine ever known. By the kindness of Alfred Deane, editor of the *Gold Hill News*, letters of introduction were given us to mine superintendents, and we prepared to make the descent the next day.

In the morning, informing that the officials would not be on duty until late, we climbed the lonely side of Davidson, 1,000 feet high, and enjoyed for an hour a view of the mines below, the valley around, the peaks beyond and the great silent desert stretching away to the east, recalling the many stories of suffering in the days of emigration. Descending the south side into the next canon again, we seek the mining officers, readily obtain permission and a guide, and are prepared for our further descent by changing clothes to a suit of heavy woolen. We were then led into the lofty building where the monster hoisting works stand over the deep shafts from which the ore and waste are taken to a swift release. But hark! There is surely enough of interest in that busy city beneath for another and last chapter.

John Bright's Wit in Debate.

Mr. Bright's humor is not verbalistic, like Mr. Disraeli's, but it resembles it, inasmuch as its manifestations have chiefly been in the direction of hitting off some person or party by a single phrase; in Mr. Bright's case involving a parallel or a comparison drawn from a source familiar to the least educated mind. Even, at least, of his happiest strokes of this sort have their inspiration from the Bible. Had Mr. Lowe wanted to say something damaging about Mr. Bright, he would, in all probability, have looked through his Homer or his thesaurus for an illustration.

When Mr. Bright desired, during the debate on the Reform Bill, to meet with ridicule the clause of which Mr. Lowe was the head, he bethought him of David's escape from Achish, King of Gath, and the character of the people who subsequently lampooned with him in the Cave of Adullam, and a new name was added to the political vocabulary.

The fearful song contained in his recent remark about Sir Charles Adderley in a letter written two months ago—"I hope he thought he was speaking the truth, but he is rather a dull man, and is liable to make blunders"—will be best appreciated by those who have the right honorable baronet. But the volume of sarcasm hidden in the parenthetical remark about the gentleman's economy who came over with the Conqueror—"I never heard that they did anything else"—is plain reading for all.